

# **GCC RECRUITMENT ACADEMY**

## **Complete End-to-End Recruiter Training Manual**

UAE • Saudi Arabia • Qatar • Bahrain • Kuwait • Oman

**Recruitment → Screening → Offer → Work Permit/Visa → Relocation → Joining → Aftercare**

2026 Edition | Recruiter & Team Leader Playbook

Compliance note: immigration, labour, localisation and licensing rules change. Recruiters must verify live requirements with the relevant government authority and employer before making commitments.

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# 1. GCC Market Fundamentals

**GCC means six countries:** UAE, Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Bahrain, Kuwait and Oman. Treat each as a separate employment market.

**Core recruiter formula:** Skill + Experience + Location + Nationality + Visa/Work Authorisation + Salary + Notice + Relocation + Licence/Qualification.

**Separate three concepts:** nationality/passport; current residence/location; current immigration/work status.

- Never treat a visit/tourist visa as employment permission.
- Never promise visa approval.
- Check expatriate eligibility/localisation before international sourcing.
- For regulated jobs, confirm licensing requirements.
- Always distinguish basic salary from total package.

## 2. End-to-End Recruitment SOP

**Master workflow:** Client requirement → market/salary validation → sourcing → recruiter screen → eligibility screen → CV submission → client interview → selection → offer → acceptance → documents → checks → medical/professional verification where applicable → work permit/visa → travel → local residency/ID → joining → probation/aftercare.

**Stage gates:** role fit, compensation fit, legal/immigration feasibility, notice/availability, relocation commitment and documentation.

## 3. Client Requirement Intake

**Mandatory questions:** title, location, permanent/contract, headcount, reporting line, mandatory/preferred skills, industry, education, certification/licence, nationality/localisation constraints, salary, basic vs total package, bonus, housing, transport, medical, flights, relocation, visa sponsorship, probation, notice and joining date.

**Output:** one-page scorecard marking each requirement Mandatory, Preferred or Not Required.

## 4. Candidate Sourcing & Boolean

**Example:** ("Cyber Security Engineer" OR "Security Engineer") AND (Azure OR AWS) AND (Sentinel OR Splunk) AND (Dubai OR Abu Dhabi OR UAE)

**Saudi:** ("Engineering Manager" OR "Development Manager") AND (Riyadh OR Jeddah OR Dammam OR Saudi)

**Search in layers:** exact city + skill → country + skill → GCC + skill → relocation-ready talent.

**Build pools:** local GCC residents, GCC-experienced expatriates, overseas specialists and GCC nationals where required.

## 5. Candidate Screening & Qualification

**Screen:** location → nationality → current employment → target location → GCC experience → skills → current package → expected package → basic vs all-inclusive → notice → visa status → relocation → benefits/family needs where relevant → interview availability.

**Commitment question:** "If the client confirms the role and package, are you comfortable relocating and proceeding through the employer's work-permit/visa process?"

**Counter-offer question:** ask whether a current-employer counteroffer would change the candidate's decision.

## 6. Salary & Total Package

**Record separately:** basic salary, housing, transport, other allowances, bonus/commission, medical, accommodation, flights, schooling/family benefits and relocation.

**Example:** AED 25K can mean AED 25K all-inclusive or AED 15K basic + AED 6K housing + AED 2K transport + AED 2K other allowance.

**Negotiation sequence:** current total → basic → benefits → minimum relocation package → whether housing/transport changes cash expectation.

## 7. Country Playbooks

**UAE:** overseas hiring uses the applicable work-permit route, including MOHRE for covered mainland/private-sector employment or the relevant free-zone authority. Confirm current visa, sponsorship, package, medical/ID/residency and relocation.

**Saudi Arabia:** Qiwa is central to employer-side employment services. Check expatriate eligibility/localisation, establishment status, profession and transfer vs overseas hire. HRSD's current service provides electronic permanent, temporary and seasonal work-visa services.

**Qatar:** employer sponsorship and government labour/immigration processes apply; Qatar Visa Centres can be relevant to overseas recruitment from participating countries.

**Bahrain:** LMRA is central to expatriate labour/work-permit processes.

**Kuwait:** private-sector expatriate hiring generally involves employer work permit and entry/residency formalities.

**Oman:** employer requests work visa under the Ministry of Labour work-permit framework. Current official guidance lists passport copy, photo, work permit and medical examination; profession on work permit must match visa application and applicant must generally be at least 21.

## 8. Visa & Work-Permit Workflow

**Generic overseas route:** selection → signed offer/contract → employer eligibility/quota/localisation check → work permit → visa → medical/biometrics/attestation as applicable → travel → local medical/residency/ID → joining.

**Transfer route:** current status → transfer eligibility → employer transfer process → contract/work-authorisation update → local ID/residency update → joining.

**Visa tracker:** owner, application date, document status, medical status, approval status, travel date, expected joining and blockers.

## 9. Documents, Attestation & Licensing

**Common:** passport, photo, signed offer/contract, education and experience evidence.

**Potential:** educational attestation, professional registration/licensing, medical, police/background documentation and prior residency/work-permit records.

**Control:** never fabricate, backdate or alter candidate documents.

**Regulated roles:** confirm exact licensing authority and requirement for the target country.

## 10. Offer & Negotiation

**Offer checklist:** title, employer, location, start date, basic, allowances, total package, bonus, medical, housing, transport, flights, leave, probation, visa sponsorship, relocation and family benefits.

**Rule:** only communicate benefits confirmed in the written offer.

## 11. Relocation & Joining

**Relocation:** passport, travel date, accommodation, airport transfer, employer contact, work-permit/visa, local medical, residency/ID, payroll and first-day instructions.

**Aftercare:** maintain contact through joining, first week and probation milestone.

## 12. Compliance & Red Flags

- Tourist/visit visa presented as permission to work.
- Expired/inconsistent passport or qualifications.
- Conflicting employment dates.
- Request to alter documents.
- Unverified localisation/expatriate eligibility.
- Unconfirmed regulated-profession licence.
- Candidate has not agreed to relocate.
- Basic vs total salary unclear.
- Verbal acceptance without written confirmation.
- Unclear or inappropriate candidate-fee request—escalate and verify.

## 13. Agency Commercial Models

**Permanent:** percentage of annual salary or fixed fee under client agreement.

**Retained:** staged retainer plus milestone/success fees.

**Contract staffing:** client billing less employment cost, with visa, payroll, insurance, leave, end-of-service obligations, benefits and overhead accounted for.

**Example:** AED 30K billing – AED 22K employment cost = AED 8K gross spread before other delivery costs.

## 14. CRM / ATS Pipeline

**Fields:** candidate, nationality, current country/city, target country/city, visa status, GCC experience, experience, role, current package, basic, expected, notice, relocation, benefits needs, passport check, education/licence, client, interview, offer, acceptance, visa, travel, joining, owner.

**Pipeline:** Sourced → Contacted → Interested → Screened → Qualified → Submitted → Interview → Final → Offer → Accepted → Documents → Visa → Travel → Joined → Aftercare.

## 15. KPI Dashboard

**Activity:** sourced, outreach, response rate, calls, qualified.

**Funnel:** qualified→submitted, submitted→interview, interview→offer, offer→acceptance, acceptance→joining.

**Commercial:** placements, revenue, average fee, gross margin, time-to-fill.

**Visa:** initiated, approved, rejected, pending, duration, visa-related dropouts.

## 16. 30-Day GCC Recruiter Academy

### Week 1 — Foundations

- Day 1 GCC countries/cities
- Day 2 nationality vs residency vs work authorisation
- Day 3 salary structures
- Day 4 visa/work-permit concepts
- Day 5 qualification

### Week 2 — Country Knowledge

- Day 6 UAE
- Day 7 Saudi Arabia

- Day 8 Qatar
- Day 9 Bahrain
- Day 10 Kuwait + Oman

### **Week 3 — Execution**

- Day 11 Boolean
- Day 12 LinkedIn/ATS sourcing
- Day 13 CV screening
- Day 14 candidate calls
- Day 15 client submissions

### **Week 4 — Delivery**

- Day 16 interviews
- Day 17 offer negotiation
- Day 18 visa/document coordination
- Day 19 joining/retention
- Day 20 KPI/funnel analysis

### **Days 21–25 — Practice**

- Five vacancy exercises
- Five qualification calls
- Ten Boolean searches
- Five package assessments
- Five visa scenarios

### **Days 26–30 — Certification**

- Client intake simulation
- Candidate submission simulation
- Offer negotiation
- Visa escalation
- Final assessment

## **17. 50 Practical Scenarios**

1. Indian candidate in India for Dubai; sponsorship not confirmed.
2. Indian candidate in Dubai on employment residency applying to Abu Dhabi.
3. Candidate quotes AED 30K without saying basic or total.
4. Saudi role may be localised; expatriate eligibility not confirmed.
5. Saudi candidate asks about family sponsorship.
6. Qatar candidate needs overseas medical/document processing.
7. Bahrain candidate has another employer's work permit.
8. Kuwait candidate passport is expired.
9. Oman profession does not match proposed visa profession.
10. Healthcare candidate lacks confirmed licence.
11. Engineering qualification needs verification.

12. Three-month notice vs immediate client start.
13. Candidate receives counteroffer.
14. Client changes salary after acceptance.
15. Candidate asks for guaranteed visa.
16. Conflicting employment dates.
17. Client requests a specific nationality without documented basis.
18. Candidate relocates only with housing.
19. Candidate wants schooling support.
20. Client quotes basic; candidate expects all-inclusive.
21. Strong candidate cannot relocate.
22. Strong GCC experience but missing certification.
23. Client wants 20 niche CVs in 24 hours.
24. Generic outreach gets poor response.
25. Submitted CVs rejected before interview.
26. Many interviews but few offers.
27. Many offers but few acceptances.
28. Accepted candidates fail to join.
29. Visa delayed by incomplete documents.
30. Candidate repeatedly delays documents.
31. Client gives no interview feedback.
32. Candidate asks whether visa costs are deducted.
33. Candidate wants to travel before work authorisation.
34. GCC resident wants to change employer.
35. Candidate is on dependent status.
36. Candidate has GCC driving licence.
37. Role requires professional licence.
38. Education certificate has name mismatch.
39. Passport and CV names differ.
40. Family flights not included in offer.
41. Candidate requests temporary accommodation.
42. Bonus eligibility is undocumented.
43. Candidate wants remote work from another country.
44. Client asks contractor to be treated as employee.
45. Candidate wants to start while visa processes.
46. Localisation issue discovered after sourcing.
47. Salary benchmark lacks city context.
48. Candidate compares salaries only by FX conversion.
49. Notice conflicts with travel date.
50. Candidate accepts while interviewing elsewhere.

## 18. Assessment Test + Answer Key

**Q:** What three identity/location fields must be separated?

**Answer:** Nationality, current residence/location, and current immigration/work status.

**Q:** Why ask whether salary is basic or total?

**Answer:** Allowances and benefits materially change package value.

**Q:** Can a recruiter promise visa approval?

**Answer:** No; approval depends on applicable authority, employer eligibility and documentation.

**Q:** What should be checked first for a Saudi expatriate role?

**Answer:** Whether the role/employer is eligible for expatriate hiring under current localisation rules.

**Q:** What Oman profession control applies?

**Answer:** Work-permit profession must match the profession on the visa application.

**Q:** Name four common documents.

**Answer:** Passport, photo, signed offer/contract, education/experience evidence.

**Q:** Why track counteroffers?

**Answer:** They are a major cause of offer withdrawals.

**Q:** What distinguishes qualified from sourced?

**Answer:** Qualified has passed agreed role, compensation, availability, authorisation and other gates.

**Q:** What KPI measures offer quality?

**Answer:** Offer acceptance and acceptance-to-joining rates.

**Q:** What should every rejection record contain?

**Answer:** Reason and next action/status.

## 19. Templates & Checklists

| Field                       | Record |
|-----------------------------|--------|
| Candidate                   |        |
| Nationality                 |        |
| Current country/city        |        |
| Current visa/work status    |        |
| Target country/city         |        |
| Total experience            |        |
| Relevant experience         |        |
| Current employer            |        |
| Current total package       |        |
| Basic salary                |        |
| Allowances/benefits         |        |
| Expected total package      |        |
| Notice                      |        |
| Earliest joining            |        |
| Relocation confirmed        |        |
| Family/benefit requirements |        |
| Passport checked            |        |

| Field                     | Record |
|---------------------------|--------|
| Education/licence checked |        |
| Other interviews          |        |
| Counteroffer risk         |        |
| Recruiter recommendation  |        |

## Client Intake Checklist

- Role/location confirmed
- Mandatory/preferred skills
- Expatriate/localisation eligibility
- Basic vs total salary
- Benefits
- Visa sponsorship
- Professional licensing
- Interview stages
- Notice/start date
- Submission format

## Visa Tracker

| Field              | Status/Date |
|--------------------|-------------|
| Candidate          |             |
| Country            |             |
| Employer           |             |
| Application date   |             |
| Work permit        |             |
| Documents          |             |
| Medical            |             |
| Visa               |             |
| Approval date      |             |
| Travel date        |             |
| Local ID/residency |             |
| Expected joining   |             |
| Blocker            |             |
| Owner              |             |
| Last update        |             |

## 20. Official Verification Sources

**UAE:** MOHRE overseas work-permit guidance for the applicable mainland/private-sector route; free-zone processes can differ.

**Saudi Arabia:** HRSD/Qiwa for current work-visa services, establishment eligibility, localisation and transfer routes. The current Instant Work Visas service page was released/updated 8 September 2026.

**Qatar:** relevant Ministry of Labour and immigration/visa channels; Qatar Visa Centres may apply to specific overseas routes.

**Bahrain:** LMRA for expatriate labour/work-permit requirements.

**Kuwait:** Kuwait Government Online and relevant labour/immigration authorities.

**Oman:** Gov.om / Ministry of Labour and Royal Oman Police for work-permit and visa requirements.

**Source currency:** prepared 9 September 2026. Immigration and labour rules change; verify the live official requirement before travel or employment commencement.

End of manual — operational training framework, not legal advice.